fought against them and committed atrocities on the innocent lives in Jaffna'.[2]

She talked about the Black Tigers and the Black Tigresses, where members would be ready to die for the Eelam at any moment. Speaking of Dhanu, Athirai said the 'human bomb did not wear spectacles but for the purpose of hiding her identity in the operation', she did. She also identified Shubha as belonging to the group of human bombs in the LTTE. She, Dhanu and Shubha had been trained together. In Rajiv Gandhi's assassination plan, Athirai claimed that Prabhakaran had chosen Dhanu from day one. Shubha was only a backup, in case something happened to Dhanu, and also to boost Dhanu's spirit from time to time.[3]

Kanagasabapathy, a Sri Lankan national, had been frequenting India since 1986. His latest entry into the country was through a secret sea route, to escort Athirai from Jaffna to Madras and then all the way to Delhi. Pottu Amman had introduced Athirai to Kanagasabapathy in March 1991. Kanagasabapathy was an old hand of the LTTE and was to help her settle in New Delhi. He kept shifting Athirai from one hideout to another in Madras before catching a train to Delhi with her. Neither Kanagasabapathy nor Athirai had ever visited Delhi before. The old man took Athirai and left for Delhi on an Indian Airlines morning flight. The understanding was that she would go to Delhi apparently to learn Hindi and how to operate a computer. She was given to understand that the duo would gather information about certain 'marked places' and 'marked Congress politicians' who would be of use in an operation later. Those who were to join her later from Sivarasan's team would stay in her Delhi house and work as her support system in liquidating the main target. The old army veteran bought a road map of Delhi and guidebooks to acquaint the girl with the city. Athirai, too, usually kept quiet in front of guests and strangers, pretending to be in mourning after her 'mother's death'.[4]

In the first week of May, Sivarasan handed Kanagasabapathy a list of VVIPs and their contact details in Delhi. The LTTE had penetrated the Indian capital. This was the most alarming revelation since Rajiv Gandhi's ghastly murder.